

Fc

Compares two files and displays the differences between them.

Syntax:

```
fc [/a] [/b] [/c] [/l] [/lbn] [/n] [/t] [/u] [/w]  
[ /nnnn] [ drive1:][ path1] filename1  
[ drive2:][ path2] filename2
```

/a: Abbreviates the output of an ASCII comparison. Instead of displaying all of the lines that are different, **fc** displays only the first and last line for each set of differences.

/b: Compares the files in binary mode. **Fc** compares the two files byte by byte and does not attempt to resynchronize the files after finding a mismatch. This is the default mode for comparing files that have the following file extensions: **.exe**, **.com**, **.sys**, **.obj**, **.lib**, or **.bin**.

/c: Ignores the case of letters.

/l: Compares the files in ASCII mode. **Fc** compares the two files line by line and attempts to resynchronize the files after finding a mismatch. This is the default mode for comparing files, except files with the following file extensions: **.exe**, **.com**, **.sys**, **.obj**, **.lib**, or **.bin**.

/lb n: Sets the **n** number of lines for the internal line buffer. The default length of the line buffer is 100 lines. If the files that you are comparing have more than this number of consecutive differing lines, **fc** cancels the comparison.

/n: Displays the line numbers during an ASCII comparison.

/t: Prevents **fc** from converting tabs to spaces. The default behavior is to treat tabs as spaces, with stops at each eighth character position.

/u: Compares files as Unicode text files.

/w: Compresses white space (that is, tabs and spaces) during the comparison. If a line contains many consecutive spaces or tabs, **/w** treats these characters as a single space. When used with the **/w** command-line option, **fc** ignores (and does not compare) white space at the beginning and end of a line.

/ nnnn: Specifies the number of consecutive lines that must